

Start Here

The whole idea, in plain language — read this before the Guide.

The problem this solves

You know your subject cold. Turning what's in your head into a course someone can actually *learn* from — one that another person could pick up and teach — is a different skill, and most experts were never taught it. So we improvise: a pile of slides, notes that only make sense to us, a lot of effort that doesn't quite land.

The one idea

A course isn't a pile of writing. It's a short chain of decisions, made in order. Decide who it's for and what they'll be able to *do*; pressure-test the plan against how people actually learn; put the whole thing on one page; then build one piece of it. Make the decisions first and the material almost writes itself — with AI drafting while you stay in charge and check every line.

Decide first → test it against how people learn → put it on one page → build one module → let AI draft, you verify.

Why it works

- **Decisions before production.** You never open a blank page and start writing — you decide first. Everything downstream inherits those choices, so the course holds together.
- **You direct, AI drafts, you verify.** GenAI is the fast production engine, never the author. The judgment stays yours.
- **The portability test.** You're finished when *someone else could teach your course from your materials alone*. That one test quietly forces clarity into everything.
- **Grounded, but usable.** Built on real instructional-design research — measurable goals, how people learn, accessible design — repackaged so an expert, not a professional designer, can follow it.

What you'll do — and keep

Work the Guide top to bottom for **one** module. You'll produce, in order: a one-page **decisions doc**, measurable **objectives**, a **course blueprint** (the Master Design Document), and one complete **module** — built, and ready to teach. That first module is your template; the rest of the course is built exactly the same way.

Then go here

1. **How to Build a Course** — the Guide, the full method step by step. Begin at “*Why I Wrote This*.”
2. **Method on a Page** — a one-page quick-reference to keep beside you *once you know the method* (shorthand, not an introduction).
3. **Worked Examples** — the whole method filled in on two real courses; open one whenever a step feels abstract.

What's in the bundle:

- 1_Guide/ — the Guide, its blank templates, and the blank module skeleton.
- 2_Worked_Examples/ — IntroML/ (a code course) and Coffee/ (a non-code course): the method filled in end to end.
- 3_Pilot_Course/ — the five-session course that teaches the method to a group.

File paths in the Guide are written from this layout. If you received the Guide on its own, the Worked

Examples ship as a companion bundle — unzip it beside the Guide.

The promise: follow it end to end and you'll have a course solid enough that someone else could pick it up and teach it.